INCH-POUND

MIL-H-44063E
7 September 1993
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-44063D
26 October 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HAM SLICE, SMOKE FLAVORING ADDED, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Department and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a thermostabilized ham slice in a flexible pouch for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat (MRE), Individual.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018 by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8905

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SPECIFICATION

MILITARY

MIL-P-44073 - Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks, and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Parts 301-399)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications for Fresh Pork, Series 400

(Copies are available from the Director, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2603, South Building, P. O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

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U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS), U.S. FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Ham. The ham shall be the equivalent of Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPS) No. 402B ham, except ham tying shall not be necessary, and all shank meat shall be removed and excluded. The ham shall be within the weight range of 8 pounds to 14 pounds and a maximum average fat thickness of 1/4 inch.

3.2.1.1 Ham, chilled. Raw ham, in the bone-in or boneless form, shall be received in the fresh-chilled state. The ham shall not have been previously frozen. The fresh-chilled ham shall be held for not more than four days after initial chilling at a temperature not to exceed 40°F prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.1.2 Ham, frozen. Raw ham, in the bone-in or boneless form, shall be received in the frozen state. The ham shall be held for not more than 120 days after initial freezing at a temperature not to exceed 0°F prior to preparation and further processing (see 3.3).

3.2.2 Water. Water used for formulation, ice making, and washing shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.3 Salt. Salt shall be noniodized, white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.4 Sugar, white, granulated. Sugar shall be white, refined, granulated cane or beet sugar, or a combination thereof, and shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.5 Sodium tripolyphosphate. Sodium tripolyphosphate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.6 Sodium ascorbate. Sodium ascorbate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.7 Sodium erythorbate. Sodium erythorbate shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.8 Flavoring, smoke, single strength. Single strength smoke flavoring shall be an oil-based liquid with a density of 7.6 pounds per gallon, a stability of greater than 30 hours (A.O.M.), and a phenolic level

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(dimethoxyphenol) of 7.3 mg to 8.1 mg per mL. The smoke flavoring shall have a mellow hickory smoke aroma (see 6.3).

3.2.9 Sodium nitrite. Sodium nitrite shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.10 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this specification. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of the cured ham. The ham shall be prepared as follows:

a. Boned and trimmed ham which meets the requirements of 3.2.1 shall be further trimmed, if necessary, to ensure compliance with the finished product requirements (see 3.6). The frozen ham shall be tempered/thawed to an internal temperature of 38°F to 42°F prior to stuffing and forming (see 3.3.1.2).

b. The boned and trimmed ham shall be reduced in size to chunk-type pieces by mechanically grinding once through a kidney-shaped plate, having openings measuring 2-1/2 inches or more in the least dimensions, and using a two-bladed knife that yields pieces weighing at least 2 ounces.

3.3.1.1 Mixing. The chunked ham pieces shall be mechanically mixed with the following cure ingredients for approximately 15 minutes or until the product becomes moderately tacky.

Ingredient	Pounds per 100 pounds of ham
Water or ice	3.0000
Salt 1/	2.5000
Sugar, white, granulated	1.0000
Sodium tripolyphosphate	0.2500
Sodium ascorbate and/or sodium erythorbate	0.0550
Flavoring, smoke, single strength (see 6.3)	0.0400
Sodium nitrite 2/	0.0156

1/ The total amount of salt in the formula shall be adjusted, as necessary, to produce a product that complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

2/ Sodium nitrite shall be of sufficient strength to ensure a complete cure without exceeding 156 parts per million of nitrite in the cured ham during preparation.

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...ble when specified by the contracting ... The following requirements are applicable

The mixture shall be held prior to or after the stuffing operation at an internal temperature of 38°F to 42°F for not less than 4 hours nor more than 72 hours before cooking to ensure uniform cure dispersion in the mixture.

3.3.1.2 Stuffing and forming. The cured ham mixture shall be formed in stainless steel molds to a size which will produce slices conforming to the size requirements of 3.3.1.5 or the cured ham mixture shall be mechanically stuffed tightly into regenerated cellulose prestuck castings. The resultant ham logs shall be mechanically formed to produce slices conforming to the size requirements in 3.3.1.5. The open ends shall be sealed to exert minimum pressure on the ham. Alternatively, canned or cooked pullman-style hams may be used (see 3.3.1.7).

3.3.1.3 Cooking. The formed ham logs shall be cooked by one of the following methods to provide a product meeting the finished product requirements.

a. Cookhouse method. The ham logs shall be cooked in a cookhouse (smokehouse with smoke) at a temperature range of 160°F to 162°F and 100 percent relative humidity until the internal product temperature reaches 150°F to 152°F.

b. Water cooking method. Water cooking is permitted only for the ham logs in cellulose casings provided they are cooked in water until the internal product temperature reaches 150°F to 152°F.

3.3.1.4 Cooling and storage. Immediately after completion of the cooking process, the cooked ham logs shall be placed in an ice water bath or cooled by other commercially acceptable cooling methods and rapidly cooled to 130°F or below. The ham logs shall be further cooled from 130°F to 80°F or below within two hours, and further cooled from 80°F to 40°F or below within four hours. The cooled, cooked ham logs shall be held for not more than 48 hours after removal from the cooking process and prior to slicing. Alternatively, if the cooked ham logs are to be held longer than 48 hours after cooking, they shall be mechanically stuffed and vacuum-sealed in heat-sealable casing materials made from FDA and USDA food approved laminate consisting of 0.0005 inch thick polyester and 0.0015 inch thick medium density polyethylene. The cooled, cooked ham logs packed in polyethylene shall be maintained at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F for a period not to exceed 60 days from the date of cooking to date of slicing.

3.3.1.5 Slicing. The ham log shall be sliced to produce slices measuring into 3 inches (± 1/4 inch) in width by 4 inches (± 1/4 inch) in length by not more than 3/4 inch in thickness. The time from slicing to filling shall be continuous. The ham slices shall be filled into the pouches within 4 hours after being sliced. End slices shall not be used.

3.3.1.6 Alternate processing for cured ham. Cured hams processed by methods other than the chunking method described in 3.3.1, such as sectioned

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and formed, or massaging of intact ham muscle shall be acceptable. If using an alternate processing method, the preparation and processing techniques of this specification, except for chunking, shall be required.

3.3.1.7 Alternate cured ham product. Canned, cooked pullman-style hams which meet the requirements of 3.3.1 and 3.3.1.1 and can be sliced to the requirements of 3.3.1.5 are acceptable. The canned, cooked pullman-style hams shall be held at a storage temperature of 28°F to 40°F for not more than 180 days from date of pack to date of slicing.

3.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch (see 5.1) shall be filled with product to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each pouch shall be filled and sealed in accordance with the pouch filling and sealing requirements specified for class 3 of MIL-P-44073.

b. Each filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within 2 hours after sealing or maintained at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F for not more than 72 hours from the time of sealing to thermoprocessing.

3.5 Pouch thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouches shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved. The thermoprocessing operation shall be in compliance with the thermoprocessing requirements for class 3 of MIL-P-44073.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be one intact ham slice per pouch.

e. The average drained weight of the ham slice shall be not less than 3.8 ounces.

f. The drained weight of the ham slice of any individual pouch shall be not less than 3.6 ounces.

g. The texture of the ham slice shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

h. The average fat content of the finished product shall be not greater than 12.0 percent and no individual pouch shall have a fat content greater than 14.0 percent.

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i. No individual pouch shall have a ham slice with adherent fat or a fat pocket measuring more than 0.5 inch by 0.5 inch.

j. The salt content of the finished product in any individual pouch shall be not less than 1.5 percent nor greater than 2.5 percent.

k. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched).

l. Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in any individual pouch shall be not more than 0.2 ounces.

m. No individual pouch shall contain a bone piece measure 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

n. No individual pouch shall contain a ham slice with a void area or air pocket measuring more than 0.5 inch by 0.5 inch.

o. The ham slice shall not contain finely ground, flaked, or otherwise comminuted product.

3.6.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The pork component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

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4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material examination. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be examined in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the standard methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch examination. Examination of the filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Product and drained weight inspection.

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4.5.4.1 Product inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65°F to 75°F) after completion of the thermostabilization operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180°F to 190°F water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the sampling plan specified in table I. The product contents shall be inspected for the defects indicated in table II.

TABLE I. Double sampling plan for product inspection 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Pouch does not contain one intact ham slice
102	Texture of ham slice is dry, rubbery, or mushy
103	Product shows evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened or scorched)
104	Total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, in any individual pouch is more than 0.2 ounces

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TABLE II. Product defects (cont'd) 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
105	Ham slice has adherent fat or a fat pocket measuring more than 0.5 inch by 0.5 inch
106	Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
107	Ham slice contains finely ground, flaked, or otherwise comminuted product
108	Presence of void area or air pocket measuring more than 0.5 inch by 0.5 inch

1/ The presence of foreign material (for example, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.6.1).

4.5.4.2 Drained weight inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65°F to 75°F) after completion of the thermostabilization operation. The pouches shall be heated in 180°F to 190°F water for approximately 10 minutes, opened and inspected. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The sample size shall be as indicated by the double sampling plan specified in table III. The drained weights shall be determined and inspected for the defects listed in table IV.

TABLE III. Double sampling plan for drained weight inspection 1/

Lot size (pouches)	Sample size (pouches)	Cumulative sample	Acceptance number	Rejection number
0 to 500,000	20	--	0	2
	20	40	1	2

1/ a. If no defects are found in the first sample, the lot shall be accepted.

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b. If the number of defects found in the first sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

c. If the number of defects found in the first sample exceeds the acceptance number but is less than the rejection number, the second sample shall be inspected. Defects found in the first and second sample shall be combined and if the number of defects in the cumulative sample equals or exceeds the rejection number, the lot shall be rejected.

TABLE IV. Drained weight defect 1/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Drained weight of ham slice in a pouch is less than 3.6 ounces. 2/

1/ To determine drained weight, the pouch contents shall be poured into a flat-bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 180°F to 190°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated so as to liquify rendered fat. The contents shall then be poured into a U.S. Standard 1/4 inch sieve in a manner that will distribute the product over the sieve. The sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at approximately a 45° angle and allowed to drain for two minutes before determining the drained weight by subtracting the sieve tare weight from the gross weight. The drained weight shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

2/ If the sample average drained weight is less than 3.8 ounces the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.5 Fat and salt content testing. Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot. The product shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of AOAC, methods 976.21, 985.15, or 960.39, and for salt content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of AOAC, method 935.47, except that preparation of the samples shall be as follows: The unopened pouches shall be gently warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the pouches. The pouches shall be opened and the entire contents of each pouch shall be separately blended in a Waring Blendor or equivalent. The test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat or salt requirements in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.5.6 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Ingredient information.

6.3.1 Flavoring, smoke, single strength. It has been found that CharOil Hickory (single strength) manufactured by Red Arrow Products Company, P.O. Box 1537, Manitowoc, WI 54221-1537 meets the requirements of 3.2.8 and performs satisfactorily in this product. The 0.0400 pounds per 100 pounds is based on the phenolic levels specified in 3.2.8. The MRE ham producer is cautioned to verify these requirements prior to formulation of the ham cure ingredients.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Combat field feeding
Operational ration
Pouch food
Shelf stable

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6.5 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8905-1114)

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-H-44063E	1993 September 7

3. DOCUMENT TITLE

HAM SLICE, SMOKE FLAVORING ADDED, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	(1) Commercial 508-651-4501	(2) AUTOVON/DSN 256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: SATNC-WRE Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 NATICK OP4, JUL 91 *Previous editions are obsolete.* 198/290

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